

10/07 WEDNESDAY — STORY OUTLINE

Airdate: Wednesday, October 7, 2026 · **Stories:** A + B + C, confirmed by the producer 9/29 (jeff_approval.md) · **Guest:** none · **Sponsor:** OmniWatch (2 breaks) · **Stage:** videos

RUNNING ORDER

Slot	What	Weight	Clips
Tease	Face-match arrest, the grocery cart watching you, the drive-thru robot backlash	—	—
A	A computer said it was her face... she spent months in jail	~45% of show	4/5
Break	OmniWatch — after A	—	—
B	Your grocery store is watching every step you take	~30%	3/3
Break	OmniWatch — after B	—	—
C	They replaced the cashier with a robot... now they're bringing the humans back	~20%	3/3
End	End of show	—	—

The show in three sentences

A computer matched a Tennessee grandmother's face to a bank thief in a state she'd never been to, and she sat in jail for months before anyone checked. The same kind of watching is in your grocery store: carts with cameras, baskets that ping the ceiling, cameras that log your aisles and your plate. Then the exhale: the fast-food chains are admitting you hated the robots and are bringing people back, and here is how to get one.

The ride

Dread builds through A (arrested at gunpoint, months inside, nobody checked), stays uneasy through B but turns practical at the phone fix, and lets go in C, which is a good-news, slightly funny close.

Decisions before we write

- A beat 2 is WEAK (reporter VO; no clip of Lipps speaking) and A beat 5 is THROTTLED (right clip, captions bot-walled). Retry both in a fresh session.
- 🌟 CBS misnames her "Lipscomb" on air, twice; A beats 4 and 6 avoid both. Outlets also differ on jail time (6 months vs 2 in North Dakota) and on which image was searched. Settle from the complaint.
- A's fix is Jeff showing the location history already on his phone; say on air that keeping it on is a privacy trade-off. Lipps is 50, just under 55+.
- B beat 2 stays (viral, but don't lean on Target). B beat 1 is a CROP (horizontal promo). B beat 3 has no person, just Lowe's own privacy statement.
- C beat 1: two TikToks pulled (McDonald's McNuggets, Taco Bell "one thousand waters"); call later. C beat 2 and C beat 3 are WEAK; graphic fallback per producer. Frame C as "bringing the humans back."

A. A COMPUTER SAID IT WAS HER FACE... SHE SPENT MONTHS IN JAIL

In one sentence: Police ran a fake-ID photo through AI face recognition, it returned a Tennessee grandmother who had never been to North Dakota, and she sat in jail for months until her own bank records freed her.

Peg: She filed a \$10 million federal lawsuit against Fargo and the detective on Sept 16; CBS, ABC and NBC picked it up that week.

Weight: ~45% of show · 5 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The hook	You (the viewer)	Police can run your face through a computer, and a match can be treated like proof.	JEFF
2	The arrest	Angela Lipps, Tennessee grandmother of five	Police arrest her while she is babysitting, for bank fraud in North Dakota, a state she has never been to.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — Lipps interview, WDAY or network
3	The match	West Fargo police investigator	A photo from the real suspect's fake ID goes into AI face recognition, and the system returns her.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — network explainer on the match
4	Months inside	Angela Lipps	She sits in jail for months until her lawyer's bank records prove she was home; charges dropped Christmas Eve.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — Lipps on the jail time
5	"Errors were made"	Dave Zibolski, then-Fargo police chief	In March the chief admits errors, apologizes and issues a new facial-recognition policy.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — March press conference
6	The lawsuit	Eric Rice, Lipps' attorney	She sues Fargo and the former detective for \$10 million in federal court.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — lawsuit coverage, CBS or KSTP
7	Could it be you	You (the viewer)	A face match is supposed to be a lead, not an ID, and many searches start from public social-media photos.	JEFF
8	Your alibi is in your pocket	You (the viewer)	Jeff opens the location history already on his phone, the kind of record that freed her.	DEMO

Videos

#	Clip	Shows	In-Out	Status
2	ABC News 4 / WCYB — Tennessee grandma mistakenly sent to North Dakota jail due to AI error	Local package: US Marshals at her Carter County house, 50-year-old grandmother of five, a state she'd never visited. Reporter voiceover.	0:16–0:31 "a state she'd never even visited"	WEAK
3	ABC News 4 / WCYB —	Attorney Eric Rice: an AI	0:31–0:46 "an arrest	PICK

	same package	program selected her face and an officer reviewed her social media; then the fake military ID bank fraud.	warrant to be issued for her" BUTT 0:46–1:00 "between April and May of 2025"	
4	CBS News — Grandmother falsely accused of bank fraud sues Fargo	Correspondent: months behind bars, couldn't make bail, bank records freed her, released Christmas Eve in the clothes she was booked in.	1:16–1:46 "the same clothes she was booked in in July"	PICK
5	KVRR — Fargo Police Chief admits mistakes were made in Lipps case	By title, the chief's admission; transcript not reached (bot wall, two attempts).	—	THROTTLED
6	CBS News — same package	Anchor intro: never set foot in North Dakota, suing Fargo; then the civil-rights and malicious-prosecution claims.	0:00–0:19 "for false arrest" BUTT 0:42–0:57 "what she believes was malicious prosecution"	PICK

Row 2: no Lipps soundbite in any transcript reached. Rows 4 and 6: CBS says "Lipscomb" at 0:32 and 1:08, outside both segments.

The fix

- **Your alibi is already on your phone.** iPhone: Settings → Privacy & Security → Location Services → System Services → Significant Locations & Routes. Android: Google Maps → your profile picture → Your Timeline. Keep it on, or know it's there. *(verify on current iOS/Android)*
- Your bank and card statements are the other half of an alibi. Know how to download them fast.
- If you're ever charged: say nothing without a lawyer, and have the lawyer demand the facial-recognition report and whether a human confirmed the match.
- Want your face out of public face-search sites? PimEyes has a free opt-out form (pimeyes.com/en/opt-out). It doesn't touch police databases. *(verify)*

Gaps

- △ Beat 2: "arrested at gunpoint" is her attorney's framing. Attribute it to him, don't state it.
- △ Beat 4: jail time varies by outlet (about six months per ABC and MPR, three per WCTI). Say "months" until the complaint is pulled.
- △ Beat 4: "lost her home and car" is from ABC's summary of the suit. Pull the complaint.
- △ Beat 7: that the search began from her social-media photo is one ABC line. Confirm in the complaint before the fix leans on it.

B. YOUR GROCERY STORE IS WATCHING EVERY STEP YOU TAKE

In one sentence: The new AI grocery carts point cameras into your basket and out at the aisle, store baskets carry beacons that talk to the lights overhead, and home-store cameras log which aisles you walked and read your plate, but you can switch off the part that ties it to your phone.

Peg: Instacart says it tripled Caper Cart deployments in a year, now 100+ cities in 15 states, rolling at Kroger, ShopRite, Schnucks, Sprouts, Wegmans, Weis and Geissler's.

Weight: ~30% of show · 3 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The AI cart	Grocery shopper with a Caper Cart	The cart has cameras into your basket and out at the aisle, a location tracker, and ads by where you stand.	FIND · VERTICAL BROLL — Caper Cart in an aisle
2	The beacon	Store worker who filmed it (Elijah, per his TikTok)	He films the black box on a store basket and calls it a tracker; 3.4 million people watch.	HAVE · VERTICAL — TikTok @user60342208753
3	The cameras	Lowe's, per its privacy statement	Cameras log which aisles you walk and how long you stay; some parking lots read your plate.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — plate cameras at a home store
4	The fix	You (the viewer)	Jeff shuts off location and Bluetooth for store apps on his phone, live.	DEMO

Videos

#	Clip	Shows	In-Out	Status
1	Instacart — Meet Caper Cart	The cart in an aisle, items dropped in, computer-vision cameras, then location-based deals and personalized ads.	0:00–0:43 "them and even add them back" BUTT 0:48–1:08 "your customer's"	PICK · CROP
2	@user60342208753 — Target basket tracker	Store worker calls the box on a basket a tracker, per caption and press write-up. Posted Aug 29.	—	MANUAL · UNVERIFIED
3	NBC Connecticut — License plate readers now at Home Depot, Lowe's	Plate cameras at a Lowe's entrance in Newington, CT, then a professor on oversight and data retention.	0:17–0:51 "now using them to prevent theft. It's an" BUTT 1:22–1:37 "accountability, data retention."	PICK

Rows 1 and 3 reused from run LIVE_10072026 and re-verified against captions this run. Row 2: no caption track, and media downloads blocked, so no Whisper.

The fix

- iPhone: Settings → Privacy & Security → Location Services → each store app → Never. Then Settings → the app → Bluetooth off.

- Android: Settings → Apps → the store app → Permissions → Location → Don't allow. (*verify on Jeff's device*)
- With location and Bluetooth off, the basket tracks a basket, not you. The cameras and plate readers don't need your phone; those you can't switch off.

Gaps

- △ Beat 2 is Target's basket. Kept (producer, 9/29): it went viral, but don't lean on the brand in copy.
- △ Beat 2: the "tracker" claim is his; Snopes confirmed the beacon tracks the basket and the store app ties it to you. Air it with that caveat.
- △ Beat 3: no named person. It's Lowe's own privacy statement plus plate-camera footage.
- Jeff's Jan 22 "These Stores Are Spying On You" covered store tracking. New here: the AI carts and the basket beacon.

C. THEY REPLACED THE CASHIER WITH A ROBOT... NOW THEY'RE BRINGING THE HUMANS BACK

In one sentence: After years of kiosks and AI drive-thru voices, Burger King says customers drove off rather than talk to the bot, and McDonald's starts retraining more than two million workers to be nicer to you.

Peg: McDonald's "Make It Golden" hospitality training starts Oct 5, two days before air. Burger King's tech chief said Sept 23 that pilot restaurants saw drive-offs.

Weight: ~20% of show · 3 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The robot fails	Drive-thru customer filming an AI order	The AI voice gets the order wrong again and again while the customer films it.	FIND · VERTICAL — viral AI drive-thru fail
2	They drove away	Chakri Somisetti, Burger King VP of brand technology	He says pilot restaurants saw drive-offs because guests didn't want to talk to a bot.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — news on the Burger King drive-offs
3	The humans come back	McDonald's worker (unnamed)	McDonald's starts hospitality training for 2 million-plus workers Oct 5, while still rolling out its AI voice.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — McDonald's retraining news
4	Get a person	You (the viewer)	Walk in and order at the counter, or ask for a person at the speaker.	JEFF

Videos

#	Clip	Shows	In-Out	Status
1	@typical_redhead_ — This McDonald's robot is wild · alt: @kristinealise — Taco Bell "one thousand waters"	McDonald's AI keeps adding McNuggets, 28 orders deep (Jan 2023, per TODAY). Alt: Taco Bell AI hands the car to a human (Jul 2025, per Daily Dot). Call later.	—	MANUAL · UNVERIFIED
2	NBC News — Burger King's new AI chatbot to improve 'friendliness'	Burger King's AI headset; "hospitality is fundamentally human," then AI drive-thru chatbots "aren't quite there yet" with a customer glitch.	1:11-1:16 "hospitality is fundamentally human" BUTT 1:24-1:44 "AI, please remove that item"	WEAK
3	Ecomix Simple — McDonald's Is Retraining 2 Million Workers	Narrated explainer: Oct 5, retraining 2 million-plus people "not on the app, on hospitality." Tiny channel, voice may be synthetic.	0:16-0:29 "Not on the app. On hospitality."	WEAK

Row 1: native TikToks; no captions and no Whisper this run. Rows 2-3: graphic fallback per producer if these don't hold up.

The fix

- Want a person? Walk in and order at the counter. McDonald's says it wants an employee on hand for anyone who prefers one. (*verify at the store*)
- At the speaker, ask for a person. (*verify what works at each chain*) Burger King's human option isn't live yet.
- Watch the order screen as you talk and fix it before you pay; check the bag before you leave the lot.

Gaps

- △ Beat 1: Jeff won't record his own drive-thru test. This needs a real customer's fail clip, and the famous ones are older (Taco Bell, McDonald's 2024). Old footage is fine, the peg is new.
- △ Beat 3: no named McDonald's person. The retraining is a company announcement.
- △ Don't say "McDonald's is hiring cashiers" (not found) or "Burger King is ditching the bot" (voice AI is still in about 1,500 drive-thrus).